



Onkyo's P3 is an NVIDIA ION based nettop with a removable DVD drive



Windows 7 Starter Edition will be replacing Windows XP as the standard OS on Netbooks and other low-cost computers

Desktop PC test



Apple iMac 24-inch

the numpad, the keyboard's smaller in width, which turns out to be a bit too small while using it on the lap. It is complimented by their "Mighty mouse", that provides fair level of accuracy. It has a tiny trackball like the Blackberry's which provides accurate scrolling. The button on the side is useful to easily switch between windows. Having just one physical clickable button is an issue when you activate the 'right-click' functionality in OS X; the response is a hit-and-miss affair. Another qualm with the mouse is that its wire is simply too short. While Apple may argue that one of the two USB ports on the keyboard can be used to connect it, its not convenient when you are

using the keyboard on your lap; as you fear the mouse might be pulled off the table.

The entry-level iMac came with a 20-inch screen (1680 x 1050) and the two above in line came with 24-inch displays; bearing a 1920 x 1200 pixel resolution. All screens portrayed very good clarity and adequate brightness. They are great to use with multimedia applications. We only complain about the glossy nature of the display, due to which the reflections, especially while seeing dark content on screen were little irritating. There are a pair of stereo speakers placed at the iMac's

belly. They belt out decent audio quality and volume.

The Mac Mini, touted as the smallest and cheapest Mac, was earlier criticised for having under-powered hardware. Apple has notably made changes that are seen in current editions. It still comes in a petite lunch-box shaped casing which is pos-

a DisplayPort to connect to a monitor. But thankfully, Apple has provided a Mini DisplayPort to DVI converter with the bundle. The only thing stopping it from being a great HTPC solution is the lack of an HDMI port. A DisplayPort-to-HDMI conversion cable could be the answer to that riddle.



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sibly one of the smallest cabinets we've seen. It's aluminium wrapping gives it solidity and rubbery grip at the base prevents it from slipping. A slot-loading optical drive sits in the front. At the back, we have a good number of USB ports and a FireWire port. On the body, it only has

Considering how portable the Macbook adapters are, the Mac Mini surprisingly has a fairly chunky one. To achieve this tiny footprint, all the internals of the Mini are fitted with laptop components. But still, it packs quite a punch when compared to a similarly-sized Nettop with its Core 2 Duo processor at 2 GHz and an NVIDIA GeForce 9400M GPU.

Apple Mac Pro



So, what do we make of all this?

All the desktops we received were designed for different uses and for different kinds. The all-in-one PC segment's Best Buy winner was the Lenovo C300. It was marginally costlier than the Gateway ZX2301 at Rs. 32,380 but it beats it in many tests. Of course,

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